BURIAL AT SEA REQUEST/AUTHORIZATION

ELIGIBILITY:
(1) active duty members of the uniformed services;
(2) retirees and veterans who were honorably discharged;
(3) U.S. civilian marine personnel of the Military Sealift Command
(4) dependent family members of active duty, retirees, and veterans of the uniformed services.

PROCEDURE: The PADD shall submit the completed form, along with required documentation to the appropriate port coordinator (see below list). Remains will be sent to the port coordinator as follows:

CREMATED REMAINS (Cremains): Cremated remains must be in a non-plastic, durable (spun bronze or biodegradable preferred) urn or other receptacle to prevent spillage during shipping. Contact the port coordinator by telephone prior to shipment, then send the packaged cremated remains via priority mail.

INTACT REMAINS (Casketed): ALL EXPENSES INCURRED DURING THIS PROCESS (SEE PORTS OF EMBARKATION NOTE BELOW) ARE THE RESPONSIBILITY OF THE PADD.
The PADD shall identify a receiving funeral home in the area of the port of embarkation. Remains, however, WILL NOT BE SHIPPED to that funeral home until a date and accommodating vessel are confirmed by the port coordinator. When contacted by the port coordinator, the PADD shall arrange for the holding funeral home to transfer the casketed remains to the receiving funeral home in the area of the port of embarkation, along with the OPNAV 5360/2. Once the receiving funeral home receives the remains, the port coordinator will inspect them and complete the checklist associated with those remains. Funeral homes that prepare and ship intact remains should contact Navy-Marine Corps Mortuary Affairs, Millington, TN to receive preparation requirements.

NOTE: Only the Norfolk and San Diego ports for embarkation accept intact casketed remains. Scheduling of committal ceremonies for casketed remains is challenging due to limited ports and vessels, and may cause long delays in the conducting of the ceremony.

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS INCLUDE:
(1) proof of service (DD Form 214, discharge certificate, retirement orders)
(2) proof of sponsor's service (see above) for dependents
(3) photocopy of death certificate (required)
(4) proof of relationship to sponsor (copy of marriage certificate, or page 2)
(5) burial transit permit or cremation certificate (required)
(6) OPNAV 5360/2 (casketed remains only)
(7) Letter of good standing (active duty only)

PORTS OF EMBARKATION/COORDINATORS

BREMERTON, WA
Commanding Officer
Naval Hospital Bremerton
Code: 015-BAS/HPO
1 Boone Road
Bremerton, WA 98312-1898
Phone: (360) 475-4392

JACKSONVILLE, FL
Branch Medical Clinic
Post Office Box 280148
Naval Station
Mayport, FL 32228-0148
Ph: (904) 270-4285

HONOLULU, HI
Navy Liaison Unit
Tripler Army Medical Center
Tripler AMC, HI 96859-5000
Ph: (808) 433-4709

NOTE: Intact/Casketed remains are only accepted at the San Diego and Norfolk ports of embarkation.

SAN DIEGO, CA
Naval Medical Center
Decedent Affairs Code: BUB
34800 Bob Wilson Drive
San Diego, CA 92134-5000
Ph: (619) 532-8305/6

NORFOLK, VA
Commander
Naval Medical Center
ATTN: Code 0210C
620 John Paul Jones Circle
Portsmouth, VA 23708-5100
Ph: (757) 953-2617/2618

If you have questions about the Burial at Sea program, feel free to contact Navy-Marine Corps Mortuary Affairs at 1-866-787-0081 and follow the voice menu.
Email: NAVMORT@navy.mil